

CULTURAL clashes

THE NEW WORLD

When the Europeans began to arrive in the Americas at the end of the 15th century, they brought new ideas that threatened traditional ways and challenged native gender roles within the diverse indigenous populations. Under attack were such things as matrilineal structures (where children belonged to their

mother's clan, not their father's), which some Native American nations followed. These included the Choctaw, the Haida, the Hopi, the Navajo, and the Tlingit nations of North America, and the Carib and Kogi nations of South America. In some nations, such as the Haudenosaunee of New York, women had a

► False narratives

Europeans often depicted indigenous people as barbaric. This 16th-century woodcut showed native Brazilian men and women half-naked as they feasted on human flesh, exaggerating the difference between Old and New World beliefs.

